

OTTOMAN FIREARMS

The military forces of the Ottoman Empire appreciated the value of muskets in warfare. At the end of the 17th century, the Ottoman Empire's occupation of large portions of southwest Europe ensured an inflow of military technology from the West. Fine examples of Ottoman snaphance, miquelet, and flintlock handguns were produced in the 18th century. Ornate decoration defines many of these pieces, with Islamic and Indian influences apparent in the use of inlaid precious metal and stones, and the sumptuous application of floral and geometric designs.



▲ FLINTLOCK BLUNDERBUSS

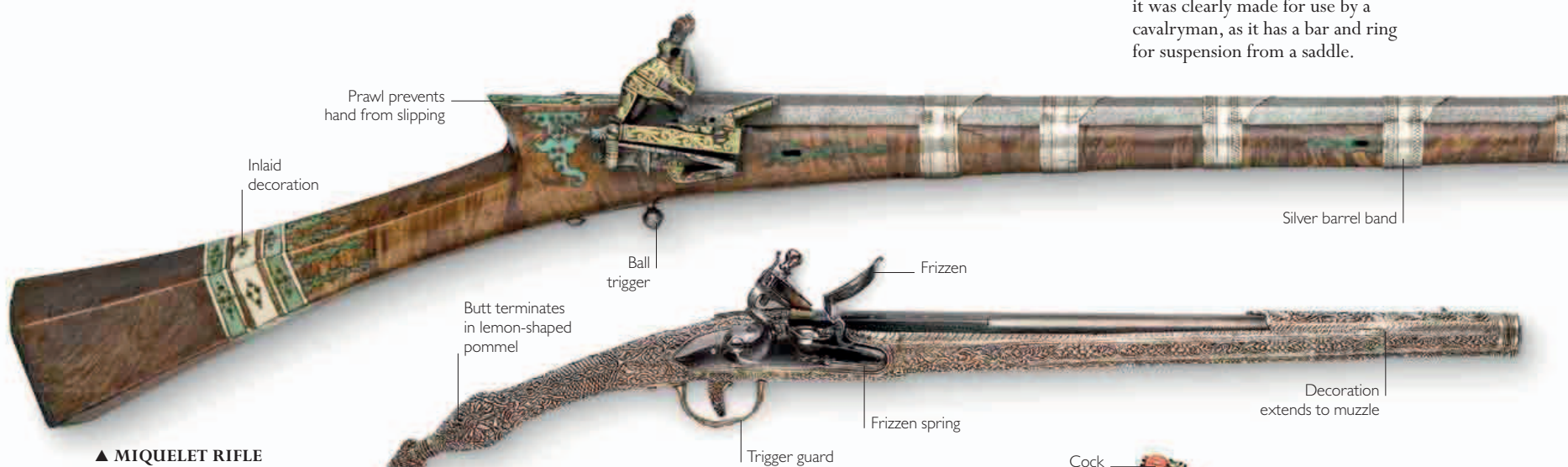
Date Early 18th century

Origin Turkey

Barrel 13½in (34.3cm)

Caliber 1.2in (30.5mm) (at muzzle)

Despite its being furnished with a shoulder stock that is incised, carved, and inlaid with silver, this blunderbuss (see p.47) is actually a large cavalry pistol. The work of “the Dervish Amrullah,” according to an engraved inscription, it was clearly made for use by a cavalryman, as it has a bar and ring for suspension from a saddle.



▲ MIQUELET RIFLE

Date 18th century

Origin Turkey

Barrel 31in (78.5cm)

Caliber .62in (16mm)

By the 17th century, the Ottoman army had adopted a version of the Mediterranean miquelet lock (see p.44) for its firearms. Most of these guns were of high quality, with rifled barrels and elaborately inlaid stocks. The lock and mounts of this example are lavishly decorated with gold inlay, while the barrel bands are silver.

▲ FLINTLOCK PISTOL

Date 18th century

Origin Turkey

Barrel 14in (35.5cm)

Caliber .65in (16.5mm)

With the gentle fall to the butt and the slim “lemon” pommel, this pistol is reminiscent of European pieces of a century or more earlier. This gun also displays the common trademark of Ottoman gunmakers: gilded decoration surrounding the muzzle.

